

Episode 106

"Please Do Not Feed the Phantasms"

Written by

Taylor Castro

Based on

"The Haunting of Dylan Klaypool: Whispers in Black Willow"

by James A. Ross

OVER BLACK:

An engine stops. A car door opens. Heavy breathing.

EXT. LIGHTHOUSE BEACH - NIGHT

CANDICE GOOD wades into water, chanting...

CANDICE
Astra intra regnum / cum omnes
erraverunt...

She puts her head all the way under.

INT. HOSPITAL, HALLWAY - DAY

NURSES rush Candice into the hospital on a gurney.

NURSE (V.O.)
Room 103. We need an IV stat.

INSERT FLASH CUTS:

- DYLAN KLAYPOOL in the passenger's seat beside MITCH
VERLICE, struggles to sleep.

- Dylan runs for her life in the woods.

A steady heart monitor BEEPS.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - DAY

Candice Good lies unconscious. JILL RODRIGUEZ approaches,
Dylan hesitant behind her.

NURSE
She won't wake up.

DYLAN
What?

INSET FLASH CUT:

- Dylan, in Mitch's car, struggles to sleep.

JILL
Mom. Mom, it's me. Your daughter.
Can you wake up for me? Mom. MOM!

Her eyes dart under the eyelids, but she stays unresponsive.

INSET FLASH CUT:

- Dylan, in Mitch's car, struggles to sleep.

- The MASKED MURDERER raises his rifle at Dylan. Clicks.

INT. MITCH'S CAR - DAY

Dylan jolts, half awake. She looks to Mitch in the driver's seat, his concern apparent. He pets her head.

MITCH
It's all right. Everything's fine.

She forces herself to sleep. Mitch's jaw tightens.

DYLAN (V.O.)
If I ask you something, do you
promise to respond with the truth?

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE - DAWN (MOMENTS EARLIER)

Mitch is loading the luggage while Dylan leans on his truck, looking out at the graveyard.

MITCH
I believe we've proven that's
really where I shine.

DYLAN
Are you gonna be like this the
whole trip?

MITCH
...Just say what you were gonna
say.

DYLAN
Do you think I really might be
losing my mind? Maybe never had one
to begin with.

He slows, coming closer.

MITCH
Why would you think that?

DYLAN
When I was being chased, I saw a
snake and it... it turned into a
broom stick and I grabbed it and
flew away through the sky like a
witch.

MITCH
...OK. OK. And you think that
didn't actually happen? That your
experience was somehow not real?

DYLAN
No. I think it somehow was real.
That's what scares me.

INT. MITCH'S CAR - DAY

Mitch sighs, then turns the radio up. Soft.

RADIO (V.O.)
This is 99.3 The Crow, you're
listening to Black Willow Bulletin.
Turning it over to politics, Mayor
Hall is putting together a rally...

He takes the exit to BOSTON.

TITLE CARD: EPISODE 6, PLEASE DO NOT FEED THE PHANTASMS.

INT. MORGAN'S OFFICE - DAY

Morgan smiles, all sunshine.

MORGAN
Ladies and Gentlemen of Black
Willow, Massachusetts. I stand
before you as your mayor, neighbor,
and friend. Together, we've endured
storms, economic shifts, and even-

She pauses, reading cue cards, then tosses them aside.

MORGAN
Damn it, Joseph, is this all we
got? It sounds like a high school
pep rally! You gonna vote for me,
Joseph? Because I what, Joseph?
Huh? Because I offered you head
behind the bleachers after second
period? Hm? No!

She paces back and forth, surrounded by two terrified
SUPERVISORS.

MORGAN
The people are scared. Terrified!
We've got what? Like three thousand
residents? And you're telling me
one of them is a serial killer?
I'll bet you anything I got that's
gonna be somebody you know. No, the
people need something that says:
your fear stops here... Anyone got
a story we can push that says your
(MORE)

MORGAN (CONT'D)
fear stops here?

SAWYER HALL peeks his head in the door.

SAWYER
Mom? You, uh, you got a second?

MORGAN
(to the supervisors)
Well, do you mind? My son needs a
second here. Thank you. Take five.

She rolls her eyes, flicks her hair.

MORGAN
Come, Dear. Talk to mommy.

She taps a seat. Sawyer approaches, handing her a coffee.

SAWYER
It's about my friend... Dakota.

MORGAN
Well, what about Dylan?

SAWYER
Not related. Dylan's fine. I mean,
all things considered. But I think
we're just friends. Maybe.

MORGAN
Hm. And this... Dakota?

SAWYER
Yeah. Uh... she confided in me and
I recommended she talk to you.

MORGAN
To me? In this political climate?
About what, Dear?

SAWYER
Our school dean. Dean Richard.
He... He sexually harassed her.

Morgan's eyes sparkle with a single thought: opportunity.

MORGAN
Well bring her to me.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - DAY

Candice's heart monitor beeps. Jill sits in a chair by her side while Miguel sits in another corner of the room, reviewing files. Neither look like they've slept much.

MIGUEL
Where's Dylan, Honey?

JILL
With Lexie.

Miguel nods.

MIGUEL (V.O.)
I need you to tell me what you've
been up to. Actually up to, I might
add.

INT. HOSPITAL, CAFETERIA - DAY (FLASHBACK)

Pudding dances on Dylan's tray. Miguel sits in front of her.

DYLAN
Why? You've never exactly been one
to believe me.

MIGUEL
Nathan had more than enough
evidence against him.

DYLAN
He hardly had any, and you know that.

MIGUEL
...I think there's a connection between Cuppa's disappearance and the jackass who tried to murder you. But I can't make any sense of it, Dylan. Not until I know what his motives might be.

DYLAN
Cuppa and I have always had one goal in common.

MIGUEL
Which is?

DYLAN
Proving you wrong.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - DAY

Miguel, reluctant, pulls out his phone and dials the CHICAGO PSYCHIATRIC HOSPITAL FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE. He speaks out of Jill's ear shot.

MIGUEL
This is Detective Rodriguez. I'm looking to speak with Nathan Klaypool.

INT. MITCH'S CAR, BOSTON AIRBNB - DUSK

Dylan sleeps with her head against the window.

MITCH
We're here.

Dylan wakes up. She does a double take, admiring the city lights and the Airbnb's exterior. Do her eyes deceive her? It's stunning.

DYLAN
You're rich!

MITCH
Woah! It's one night, Dylan.

DYLAN
That's something only a rich person
would say. What else are you
hiding?

MITCH
Not my feelings. That's for sure.

Mitch opens the car door.

EXT. BOSTON AIRBNB - DUSK (CONTINUOUS)

Dylan exits the truck, struggling after Mitch.

DYLAN
OK. I think we need to set some
boundaries for the evening. Yeah?

MITCH
Yeah. Sure. I love it. Let's set
some boundaries... over dinner?

He holds up a Chinese take-out bag while walking into the
house, leaving Dylan all fumed up.

DYLAN (V.O.)
No spontaneous confessions of love.

INT. BOSTON AIRBNB, BEDROOM - NIGHT

Mitch and Dylan eat Chinese food in a room with double beds.

MITCH
I personally happen to admire my
sense of authenticity in the face
(MORE)

MITCH (CONT'D)
of rejection.

DYLAN
Well stop it.

MITCH
Fine. Then you've gotta stop
looking at me the way you do.

DYLAN
What way?!

MITCH
You know.

DYLAN
If anyone looks at anyone a certain
way, it's you. Mr.

Dylan gives Mitch an intense, borderline creepy stare. Mitch
LAUGHS, throws a chopped veggie at Dylan.

MITCH
I'm JOKING.

DYLAN
Yeah, OK... We sleep in different
beds. That's a given.

MITCH
Sure.

DYLAN
Anything else?

MITCH
Just do me a favor? Don't talk
about Sawyer.

DYLAN
Don't talk about Carrie.

A linger.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - NIGHT

Jill wakes up with a book on her lap, still sitting beside her mom. Miguel is nowhere it be seen. She's about to leave when the noise stops her: a distant lullaby.

CANDICE (V.O.)
Astra intra regnum / cum omnes
erraverunt...

JILL
...Mom?

Jill turns, on edge. Her mom is right there, alive. She looks out the window. Nothing. Out of nowhere, her book breaks open. The pages flip wildly, landing on one with only these words: "Dedicated to my daughter."

DORTHY (V.O.)
Indeed! Indeed! We are witches!

INT. SALEM 1692, IPSWICH PRISON - NIGHT

DOROTHY GOOD is guided by a MAN across occupied prison cells.

DOROTHY (V.O.)
I am learned from birth! I wrote my
name in the devil's book. I gave my
blood to the snake! Now lead me to
my mother!

Dorothy is shoved into a cell.

DOROTHY
Mom.

SARAH GOOD writhes on the floor, sweat-soaked and screaming. TITUBA kneels beside her.

TITUBA
Keep her still.

Dorothy rushes to Sarah's side, clutching her hand as another scream breaks through. Blood pools on the floor.

DOROTHY
Tituba! Will she live? ...Tituba!

Tituba grabs Dorothy's face, her hands bloody.

TITUBA
Do you trust me, Child?

Dorothy hesitates.

TITUBA
By my word I give an oath that your mother shall live. She must only take my instruction.

Sarah lets out a gut-wrenching SCREAM.

INT. AIRBNB, BEDROOM - NIGHT

Dylan wakes up, also SCREAMING. A hand covers her mouth. It's only Mitch. He turns on the lamp and hugs her. It lasts.

DYLAN
Sorry. I get nightmares about The Crucible sometimes. It's stupid.

MITCH
What kind of nightmares?

He hands her water.

DYLAN
Mostly about Sarah Good and Tituba.
But there's always a little girl in
(MORE)

DYLAN (CONT'D)
my nightmares, maybe 4-years-old.
And she gets accused too because-

MITCH
Dorothy Good?

DYLAN
What did you just say?

MITCH
She's real, Dylan. Dorothy Good was
the youngest person accused during
the Salem Witch Trials.

DYLAN
...Violet. Was Violet real?

MITCH
Tituba's daughter...

DYLAN
I thought, I thought Dorothy was
just symbolic.

MITCH
For what?

DYLAN
Me.

MITCH
...Your grandmother. What's her
last name?

Dylan's eye shoot up at him.

EXT. BOSTON SIDEWALK - DAY

Boston looks beautiful, windswept and snowy. Dylan sits on a
curb alone, hugging herself and appearing deep in thought.

MITCH (O.S.)
Hear me out.

She looks up. Mitch has returned, handing her a coffee.

DYLAN
OK.

They walk down the street, sipping.

MITCH
Paranormal Nobodies: A Paranormal
Investigation and Awareness Agency.

DYLAN
What?

MITCH
Well, it sounds like "pair of
normal nobodies"-

DYLAN
No, I got that. OK, no I didn't.
That's actually very clever. But
what are you talking about?

They come up to a townhouse.

MITCH (V.O.)
That is how we'll introduce
ourselves to whoever keeps sending
in that case.

Mitch knocks. He winks at Dylan and her brows furrow. SANDRA
HUGH (late 40s) opens the door. She looks vaguely familiar.

SANDRA
Hello. Can I help you?

DYLAN
...You're Sandra Hugh.

INT. SANDRA'S HOUSE - DAY

Mitch bites a fruit cake, trying to pretend it's not gross.
Sandra emerges from the kitchen with tea and snacks.

SANDRA
I suppose you want my alibi, but
I'm afraid it'll be in vain. He
threatened to kill me if I used it.

DYLAN
You're own dad?

SANDRA
...I thought perhaps I could clear
Raymond's name and still survive if
only I-

DYLAN
Disappeared.

SANDRA
Yes. But know this. I loved Raymond
very much. My father is a conniving
and bigoted man, fake to the core.
He'll stop at nothing.

MITCH
He's dead though. No? ...Sorry.

SANDRA
All it takes is an alias, Son. A
few alterations, and a desire to
stay out of sight. I should know.

MITCH
But everyone thinks he's innocent.
So why hide?

DYLAN
...Sandra. Was anyone else in
recent contact with you about this?
Clearing Raymond's name?

SANDRA
Well. An old neighbor of mine, but
I haven't heard from her in months.

Mitch and Dylan look at one another, on the brink.

DYLAN
What. Neighbor?

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM, 1989 - DAY

VHS footage from 1989. Candice points it at a mirror, waving to herself. She films YOUNG JILL (17) sitting, reading.

CANDICE (O.S.)
Say hello, Jill. What are you
reading about?

JILL
Chemistry.

CANDICE
Oh, I'll tell you about chemistry.

Candice turns to the couch and there they are: YOUNG SANDRA and RAYMOND COLE.

CANDICE
Introduce yourselves, lovebirds.

SANDRA
Hi, I'm Sandra. I'm seventeen?

She giggles, feeling awkward for announcing her age.

RAYMOND
I'm Raymond. Eighteen.

He smiles. The camera falls.

RAYMOND (O.S.)
Thanks for letting me hide from Mr.
Hugh here, Ms. Good.

CANDICE (O.S.)
Aw!

The video changes...

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, 1989 - NIGHT

Frantic movements. Candice runs downstairs as SIRENS sound.

YOUNG JILL
Mom! What was that? What happened?

CANDICE (O.S.)
I heard a gunshot.

YOUNG JILL
I heard three!

Through the window: police cars rush to "Hell House."

CANDICE (O.S.)
It's the Hughs...

Candice runs to the front door.

YOUNG JILL
Mom, be careful!

CANDICE (O.S.)
Try calling Sandra, Sweetie.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, 1989 - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

There is a blur of color paired with the sound of running
and bated breath as Candice runs to her back yard.

She scans the scene outside Hell House, zooming in on MR. HUGH. He looks right at the lens. The video changes...

INT. HELL HOUSE, LIVING ROOM, 1989 - NIGHT

The camera positioned under some blankets. Candice sneaks away from it, finding her own spot to hide. An OFFICER enters, in conversation with Michael Hugh.

POLICE OFFICER
You said this man, Raymond Cole,
he's been harassing your daughter,
a minor, for how long now?

MR. HUGH
Oh, six months at least.

POLICE OFFICER
And no one in the family allowed
him access into the residence?
Because according to your wife-

Mr. Hugh pulls out a blank check and hands it to him.

MR. HUGH
Not a one.

The police man stares at him, takes the check.

POLICE OFFICER
Thank you for your time, Mr. Hugh.

The police man leaves just as Sandra runs downstairs, crying.

SANDRA
WAIT! WAIT!

Mr. Hugh holds her back, aggressive.

MR. HUGH
What do you think you're doing?

A LOW BATTERY SIGN blinks on the screen's corner.

SANDRA
I don't care if you kill me! I'd
rather die than have the world
think you're innocent.

MR. HUGH
Did I not say no slaves in the
house?

SANDRA
You're disgusting. You deserve to
rot in prison. You killed my
boyfriend in cold blood.

He SLAPS her.

MR. HUGH
And I'd do it again.

A sound comes from where Candice is. Mr. Hugh turns, alert.

MR. HUGH
WHO'S THERE?!

Camera out of battery, the video goes black.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, ATTIC - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Candice sees her current reflection on the black screen.

SANDRA (O.S.)
Last summer, she found a VHS camera
that had been lost in the estate
for years. Apparently she'd left it
there in a hurry.

She pulls out the tapes, prizing them.

SANDRA (O.S.)

(CONT'D)

After the house was abandoned, she searched and searched but could never find the camera. That is, until last Summer when Raymond's... spirit showed her where it was. I guess my father never knew what was on it.

Candice writes a letter titled, "Dear Sandra."

SANDRA (O.S.)

(CONT'D)

Whatever was recorded, Candice said it was all the proof I'd need.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, MAILBOX - NIGHT

Candice walks out into the night air, closing her robe. She slips the letter inside, and heads back.

DYLAN (O.S.)

What happened to the footage?

Something stops her cold. Candice turns around, eyeing the empty street. Unafraid. She goes inside.

SANDRA

I have no idea.

A masked face watches her close the front door.

INT. SANDRA'S HOUSE - DAY

Sandra sips tea.

SANDRA

I haven't heard from her since.

DYLAN

She's in a coma at Saint Barbara's Medical Center. And I'm her grand daughter, Dylan Klaypool.

SANDRA

Jill's girl?!

Sandra processes this, eyes getting red. She looks down at a FRAMED polaroid of her and Raymond as teens.

SANDRA

She's the one who introduced us.

Dylan half smiles, sad, and her eyes wander to Mitch.

EXT. BOSTON SIDEWALK - DAY

Dylan and Mitch walk down the street towards Mitch's truck, brisk. Thunder sounds and wind rises.

MITCH

Miguel's right. Your grandma was on the run. Maybe from the same guy who tried to kill you?

DYLAN

Oh. Um. Maybe. Yeah she wanted to disappear. The same way Sandra did.

MITCH

Shit! The blood pouring from walls on the night of you mom's podcast! It was him... Ah but he was just trying to derail us back then. Why the escalation? Dylan? Dillstick?

Mitch turns around. Dylan has completely halted.

MITCH

What's up?

DYLAN
...Maybe we should back off.

MITCH
What?

Dylan reacts to his tone and he softens.

MITCH
What makes you say that?

DYLAN
Well... m-my dad. Isn't this all
off course kind of? I mean, let's
say we find these tapes and clear
Raymond's name. We don't exactly
need to prove ghosts exist to do
that, do we?

MITCH
Well no, not necessarily. But-

DYLAN
Right. So we can just tell Miguel
what we discovered, let him handle
it, and...

MITCH
(soft)
And what, Dylan?

DYLAN
Run away.

Mitch laughs.

MITCH
Run away? You wanna run away
together?

DYLAN
They did.

MITCH

They were alone! We have each other.

Dylan cringes at this, like it was salt in a wound.

DYLAN

You don't understand.

MITCH

Then help me understand.

DYLAN

This case is alive, Mitch. That ghost isn't just some guy from 1867. It's my mom's old friend. My grandma is in the hospital.

MITCH

I know.

DYLAN

No, you don't. You never understand the gravity of things. You think all of this: ghosts, demons, psych wards, death. You think it's cute. That it's aesthetic. Some sort of game. But it's not! It's not. And-

MITCH

I never think death is cute.

DYLAN

Ghosts are death!

MITCH

They're not! They're life enduring!

Dylan laughs.

DYLAN

That! Right there! No. No, Mitch. They're pain enduring. They're-

MITCH
PROOF. That something endures! That
it doesn't just end. It can't just
end.

DYLAN
I DON'T CARE.

MITCH
You don't care? You don't care? You
don't care about what your grandma
risked her life for? About Sandra?
Or Raymond? Or what your dad got
put away for?

DYLAN
NOT MORE THAN I CARE ABOUT YOU!

Mitch blinks as Dylan backtracks, staring at her shoes. It's
raining by now.

DYLAN
Not more than I care about us.

Mitch walks towards Dylan, gently cups both hands around her
jaw, and kisses her.

INT. MORGAN'S OFFICE - DUSK

Morgan sits at her desk across from an uncomfortable Dakota.

MORGAN
Dakota, I just want you to know I
think you're incredibly brave.

DAKOTA
Thanks.

Morgan leans forward.

MORGAN
I say we do more than put this guy
(MORE)

MORGAN (CONT'D)
behind bars. I say we take it
public.

DAKOTA
No, I don't-

MORGAN
You could be a voice for the
people, Dakota. Tell your story.

DAKOTA
No, Mayor Hall, I don't want this
out there. I just wanted t- to talk
about it. Maybe make sure he wasn't
a danger to anyone else. That's it.

MORGAN
Oh, but that's just it, Dakota. He
is a danger. To all the other girls
at that school. And let me tell you
the more we pump that reputation
up, the safer it'll be for all.

Dakota shakes her head.

DAKOTA
Thank you, Mayor Hall, but... I'm
not ready for that. I'm very very
uncomfortable with, with all of it.

Morgan's smile fades.

MORGAN
Of course. If you change your mind,
my door is open.

Dakota rises, forcing a polite smile as she leaves. Once
alone, Morgan shifts. She picks up her phone.

MORGAN
Hey, Joseph. Listen.

INT. MITCH'S CAR - NIGHT

Mitch drives Dylan. He locks his hand into hers. She looks at their hands, at him: his profile in the glow of street lamps and shadowed rain, hair still wet. He does a double take at her and grins, chewing gum.

MITCH
What?

DYLAN
Nothing.

MITCH
You think I'm hot? You think I'm hot.

DYLAN
Shut up.

Mitch kisses her hand.

MITCH
It's ok, Dillstick. You're hotter.

Dylan rolls her eyes, all red.

EXT. OPEN FIELD - NIGHT

Dylan is between Mitch's house and her's.

MITCH (V.O.)
It's settled then. We'll pass the info to Miguel and hideout until they get the guy.

She looks up, spinning, swallowing rain water like it's snowflakes.

DYLAN (V.O.)
And then find some other way to
(MORE)

DYLAN (V.O.) (CONT'D)
 prove ghosts exist.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

Dylan opens the front door and shakes off the rain, bubbly.

DYLAN
 Miguel! I have something to tell
 you.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Dylan enters the living room.

DYLAN
 Migue-

He's sitting with Jill. They need to tell her something.

DYLAN (V.O.)
 93% of communication is considered
 nonverbal.

MIGUEL
 It's your dad... I called to check
 up on him and...

His words blur. All she sees is Miguel's shoulder, his jaw
 moving somewhere in the distance.

DYLAN (V.O.)
 I suppose that's how I once went 7
 years without saying a single
 thing.

Dylan's focus shifts to a small, lit candle behind Miguel.

MIGUEL
 (muffled)
 It happened four days ago. Your mom
 (MORE)

MIGUEL (CONT'D)
had just paid him a visit.

JILL
(muffled)
He was bad, Dylan. The disease...

DYLAN (V.O.)
But you forget a little, where the
feeling is.

Somewhere in Dylan's peripheral vision, Jill reaches out a hand. Dylan flinches away and locks in on Jill like she's a stranger.

DYLAN (V.O.)
When words fly like that through
the enclosure of your throat.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Dylan writhes on the floor, struggling to breathe.

NATHAN (V.O.)
You can't run away from the past...
It's just not worth it to be
angry... we're all a little
haunted, aren't we? Aren't we?

MITCH (V.O.)
We're all a little haunted, aren't
we?

Dylan gasps at the comparison, freezing still.

MORGAN (V.O.)
We can no longer live in fear!

EXT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY - NIGHT

Dakota RUNS across campus, her breath strained. Sawyer is at her tail. Behind Dakota, distant, Mayor Hall speaks to the

PEOPLE. A projector shows her face close up.

MORGAN

No longer cower from the truth!

DYLAN (V.O.)

My dad once said the stars would
force me to feel, no matter how
much they had to realign...

SAWYER

Dakota! Dakota, wait! I'm sorry.

DAKOTA

I fucking... I trusted you.

SAWYER

I had no idea she was gonna put it
on a damn projector for the whole
town to see. Remember? She said-

DAKOTA

But why does she even know?! That
was so private, Sawyer. So fucking
private. And you- you know what?
No. I can't do this. I can't even
look at you right now.

SAWYER

Dakota-

DAKOTA

Please just leave me alone. You
have no idea how humiliated-

SAWYER

You shouldn't feel humiliated.

DAKOTA

Don't tell me how to feel!

SAWYER

I'm sorry.

DAKOTA

OK. And? Sorry doesn't do shit.
Sorry doesn't fix this. This is
fucked. I'm fucked. I can never
show my face in this town again
without being the girl that got-

She completely breaks down. Sawyer tries to comfort her, but she brushes him off.

DYLAN (V.O.)

...but try hard as I do...

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BATHROOM - NIGHT

Dylan's phone vibrates wildly. It's Mitch, sending her text after text to ask what happened to her dad. He tries a call.

Dylan lays in the bathtub, emotionally empty. A cockroach crawls across the rim. She watches it, no reaction.

DYLAN

...I don't feel like he's dead.

INT. HALL RESIDENCE - NIGHT

Sawyer leans on the kitchen island, a BEER in hand.

REPORTER (ON TV)

In politics today, Mayor Hall's
polls for reelection are through
the roof after-

Sawyer shuts the TV off. He hears someone OPENING the front door, wipes his eyes. Morgan is on the phone, elated.

MORGAN

No way! You're shitting me. Tell
her I'm free Tuesday for lunch. All
right? Wait does she want the kid?
Eh I'll try it. No promises.

SAWYER

Dakota won't want to have lunch with you, Mom.

MORGAN

Is that a beer? Hey. You should be happy! Thanks to me that man'll be behind bars. It's a win win.

Sawyer laughs, bitter.

MORGAN

What? What?

SAWYER

Nothing... Dakota doesn't need a win, Mom. That's just you.

MORGAN

Need I remind you who told me her story in the first place?

SAWYER

For help! For someone to talk to! Whatever, forget it. You're evil.

MORGAN

HEY.

SAWYER

It's true!

Morgan closes her eyes.

MORGAN

I admit that sharing Dakota's story might help in the reelection, but there are worse things than an ethical side effect.

SAWYER

It just wasn't your story to tell.

He leaves her.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Dylan sits at her desk, staring out the window. Emotionless.

MS. MARRERO (V.O.)
Mrs. Rodriguez, thank you for
taking the time to speak with me.

The clock rushes through all hours of the night. She's awake.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, HALLWAY - DAY

Dylan walks through the hallway, bypasses Mitch. He turns like it was a stab wound: being invisible again.

MS. MARRERO (V.O.)
I'm calling out of deep concern for
your daughter.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Another night, new pajamas, the same spot.

MS. MARRERO (V.O.)
It seems she hasn't spoken in three
days, even when called upon.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, MS. MARRERO'S CLASSROOM - DAY

Dylan in class. Everyone looks to her. She has no reaction.

MS. MARRERO
I hardly think she's sleeping.

Mitch leans in close, whispering gently to Dylan. It makes no difference. Mitch breathes heavily, exchanging a concerned glance with Ms. Marrero.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BEDROOM - NIGHT

Another night, new pajamas, the same spot. Mitch is there, pleading Dylan to look at him.

MITCH
(muffled)
...I like it when you're mean to me
and I like it when you're sweet to
me. I like every broken and bruised
and bizarre thing about you and I
can't help it no matter how hard I
try. Please just talk to me...

Dylan's void almost breaks.

DYLAN
Go away.

Mitch looks at her, sobbing. And he goes away.

EXT. GRAVEYARD - NIGHT

Mitch digs while crying. He thrusts the shovel into the ground and keeps hitting it. A little harder every time.

INT. BLACK WILLOW ACADEMY, CAFETERIA - DAY

Mitch watches Dylan eat alone.

VEDA
I missed the meat here. And I got
us a gig. Tonight...

Mitch ignores her. Veda's glares at Dylan. She grabs her tray, walks to Dylan, and DUMPS the food on her.

MITCH
VEDA!

Everyone stares. Dylan looks at Mitch, then runs away.

VEDA
Can you hear me now?

MITCH
Oh I'm sorry. Was the death of my
girlfriend's dad and her subsequent
ghosting me getting in the way of
your congratulatory speech?

SAWYER (O.S.)
Girlfriend?

They turn to see Sawyer, who just entered.

MITCH
That's not how I planned to tell
you.

SAWYER
Just... forget it.

Sawyer leaves.

MITCH
Sawyer, I'm sorry, Man! We booked a
show. Are you coming?

He's gone. Mitch kicks the ground.

INT. GIRL'S RESTROOM - DAY

A dirty Dylan walks right into Carrie.

CARRIE
What the hell, Dylan?!

They lock eyes. Dylan goes to a stall. Carrie hears her cry.

CARRIE
(sighs)
Dylan, I told you. This is where
(MORE)

CARRIE (CONT'D)
people come to... shit.

A beat. She opens the stall.

CARRIE
Are you ok? Veda?

Dylan nods.

CARRIE
She's such a bitch.

DYLAN
...He's back. He's gone.

CARRIE
Who's he? Mitch?

Silence. Carrie almost leaves.

DYLAN
Mitch is safer without me. Ghosts.

Carrie furrows her brows, sits next to Dylan.

CARRIE
Lovey, look at me. Mitch is a big
boy, OK? And he's only afraid of
one thing: the living.

Dylan leans onto Carrie's shoulder. Carrie looks at her
dirty shirt, annoyed, but settles.

DYLAN
...Parker cheats on you.

Carrie looks at her: like hell he does.

EXT. MITCH'S CAR, SCHOOL PARKING LOT - DAY

Mitch walks to his car. Carrie approaches.

CARRIE
What the hell happened to Dylan?

MITCH
Since when do you care?

Mitch opens the door. Carrie slams it shut.

CARRIE
You're not getting it, Douchebag.
She was mute like a mental patient.

MITCH
I do get it. But there's nothing I
can do about it, OK?

CARRIE
"He's back. He's gone. Mitch is
safer without me. Ghosts?" That
mean anything to you?

MITCH
She said that? ...Thanks for
letting me know.

CARRIE
...Sure.

She leaves.

EXT. SCHOOL PARKING LOT - DAY (CONTINUOUS)

Carrie walks around a corner and finds Parker.

PARKER (O.S.)
I thought we agreed you wouldn't
talk to him.

CARRIE

That's funny 'cause I though we
agreed you wouldn't fuck my best
friend.

She walks away like it's nothing. Parker punches the wall,
hurting his hand. He turns away, makes a call.

INT. HODGE RESIDENCE, BATHROOM - DAY

Lexie grips the edge of the toilet, slowly straightening.
Her phone buzzes-- PARKER. She hesitates, then answers.

PARKER (V.O.)

Hey, fucking whore! Do me a favor
and lose this number, all right?

The line goes dead. Lexie lowers the phone, hand shaking.

She pulls open a drawer beneath the sink, rifling through
empty makeup containers and loose toiletries. Nothing. She
slams it shut. She opens another drawer, her hands moving
faster, desperate.

LEXIE

Come on, where are they?

She grabs an old pill bottle, shaking it. Empty. Her gaze
catches on a small box wedged in the corner. She pulls it
out, sets it on the counter, and lifts the lid. Her breath
hitches, fear and disbelief wash over her.

Inside of the box is THE MASK.

REVEREND (O.S.)

Confess thy sins, or perish.

EXT. SALEM 1692, PROCTOR'S LEDGE - DAY

A sunless, stormy day. Tituba and Dorothy are held back by
MEN and CHAINS. PURITANS surrounding them, all looking
ahead.

REVEREND (O.S.)
 We ask thee one last time. Denounce
 the devil, and we shall spare thy
 life.

Spoken simultaneously with:

DOROTHY
 MOTHER!

TITUBA
 (pleading)
 Confess it, Sarah! Confess!

Sarah Good stands beside FOUR OTHER WOMEN, all with a noose
 around their neck that's connected to a tree.

SARAH
 I CONFESS. I confess to wrath... To
 lust. To a life of envy and sloth.
 To the lovelessness inside my soul
 for the barren planes of thou
 hateful, greedy hearts. My infant
 lies dead in a prison but two hours
 old, and I name her MERCY. For all
 is gone from Salem! Yes I confess
 my sins, but should I die so be it.
 For of them all, I shall not lie.

Sarah locks eyes with Tituba.

REVEREND
 Tituba, dost thou hold true to thy
 word of having seen Sarah Good
 bewitched by the devil?

Everyone looks at Tituba...

SARAH
 (singing)
 The Lord is compassionate and
 gracious / Slow to anger, abounding
 in love.

The Puritans respond with mixed reactions, some afraid and others moved. The accused follow Sarah's lead, in harmony.

PURITIAN
They charm us!

Yelled simultaneously with:

PARITIAN 2
It is but a psalm!

REVEREND
Tituba, speak!

Spoken simultaneously with

DOROTHY
MAMA!

SARAH AND ACCUSED
(singing)
He will not always accuse, nor will
he harbor His anger forever / He
does not treat us as our sins
deserve or repay us according to
our iniquities.

Heard simultaneously with:

REVEREND
Speak now or stand with them! Didst
thou see Sarah Good dance with the
devil?

VIOLET WARCLOUD pushes through the crowd.

VIOLET
Mother!

DOROTHY
TITUBA!

Tituba looks between Violet and Dorothy, then the reverend.
A beat.

TITUBA
Indeed I did.

A kick, and all the accused are hung.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BATHROOM - NIGHT

Dylan lays in the bathtub, sound asleep as the doorbell
RINGS repeatedly. THE SHADOW MAN wisps into the room.

DOROTHY (V.O.)
You promised.

Dylan's eyes bolt open, her chest contorting.

INT. DYLAN'S HOUSE, FRONT DOOR - NIGHT

Carrie opens the unlocked front door with eerie hesitation.

CARRIE
Dylan? Dylan's mom? Hello? I just
came to... check on Dylan.

JILL (O.S.)
Carrie?

Carrie turns to see Jill entering with groceries.

JILL
What a surprise-

A piercing CRY shatters the overhead lights, raining shards
of glass and sending both women into near pitch blackness.

JILL
Dylan.

Jill abandons her groceries and sprints upstairs, Carrie close behind.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, DYLAN'S BATHROOM - NIGHT

Jill opens the door and the shadow man runs through her. She blinks, unable to process it, as Carrie comes in from behind and SCREAMS.

EXT. SMALL OUTDOOR CLUB, BACKSTAGE - NIGHT

Mitch paces backstage while Veda prepares to perform. Sawyer runs in. Mitch exhales, grateful for him.

ANNOUNCER (O.S.)
Next band we've got comes from
right here in Black Willow. Let's
hear it for Stupid Ball Pit Cult!

Carrie runs in, pushing through GUARDS. Her face is tear stained, her hands and shirt bloody.

CARRIE
Let me through! Get your hands off
of me! Mitch! Mitch!

MITCH
Carrie?

VEDA
Mitch. Come on.

MITCH
(to guards)
It's fine. She's with me.

The guards let her pass, but Veda gets in the way.

VEDA
Actually, you need a pass.

CARRIE
Fuck off, Veda.

VEDA
Hey!

MITCH
Let her through.

VEDA
What?

ANNOUNCER
Uh... Stupid Ball Pit Cult?

VEDA
Go on stage!

MITCH
There's obviously something going
on here!

CARRIE
There is. It's Dylan. We don't know
what happened. I was there and we
heard this scream. And there was
all this blood. I don't- I don't-

MITCH
Carrie! Just tell me she's alive.
Please!

CARRIE
She is, but-

VEDA
Too bad.

Mitch gives Veda the worst look he has.

MITCH
Where is she now?

CARRIE
The emergency room.

MITCH
Let's go.

Veda holds Mitch back.

CROWD (O.S.)
(chanting)
STUPID BALL PIT CULT. STUPID BALL
PIT CULT. STUPID BALL PIT CULT.

Heard simultaneously with:

VEDA
If you leave, I am no longer your
friend.

MITCH
(to Sawyer)
It's all yours, Homie.

Mitch tosses him the mic then looks at Veda, still speaking
to Sawyer.

MITCH
I'm sorry for not doing that
earlier.

Mitch looks to Sawyer now.

MITCH
And for everything else.

Sawyer nods, overwhelmed. Veda holds Carrie back.

VEDA
It's not too late for our plan.

CARRIE
You're sick.

Veda watches them go.

EXT. SMALL OUTDOOR CLUB, STAGE - NIGHT

Sawyer's beaten converse step onstage. THUNDER rolls.

SAWYER
Hello-

The mic screeches and the CROWD covers their ears.

SAWYER
Sorry.

A soft drizzle. He looks out, and sees her: Dakota. The performance begins, intercut with...

INT. MITCH'S CAR - NIGHT

Mitch tries to focus on the road.

MITCH
Tell me more.

CARRIE
It was so bad. Her cry- like, like
no one had ever felt that much
pain. And... she was in the bath,
Mitch. Full of blood just like-

MITCH
It wasn't her.

CARRIE
I'm pretty sure it was her in
there.

MITCH
No. I mean, it wasn't... she wasn't
trying to-

CARRIE
Mitch-

MITCH
SHE WASN'T, OK? Please just... just
trust me on this.

CARRIE
But-

MITCH
NO.

Seeing Mitch's eyes redden and his hands tense, Carrie looks away and finds rolls of toilet paper at her feet. She picks one up, looks at Mitch.

MITCH
Sorry about that.

Mitch gets a better look at the toilet paper. Tears stream down his face.

MITCH
No I'm not.

EXT. SMALL OUTDOOR CLUB, STAGE - NIGHT

It's a full downpour by the time Sawyer hits his chorus.

EXT. EMERGENCY ROOM - NIGHT

Mitch and Carrie run from his car into the emergency room.

INT. EMERGENCY ROOM - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Mitch and Carrie run to the ER. A security guard stops them.

JIM
Family only past this point.

MITCH
That's not happening.

JIM
Excuse me?

CARRIE
Mitch...

MITCH
That is NOT happening.

JIM
Son, you're not allowed-

MITCH
You have to let me in. Jim? Please.
Please! I'M NOT FUCKING KIDDING LET
ME IN RIGHT NOW!

CARRIE
MITCH!

The security guard reaches for his taser.

MIGUEL (O.S.)
They're with me.

Mitch looks at Miguel, eternally grateful.

EXT. SMALL OUTDOOR CLUB, STAGE - NIGHT

The crowd is singing with Sawyer by this point. Everyone except for Dakota, who's too in awe. The song simmers.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - NIGHT

The door creaks open. Miguel, Mitch, and Carrie step inside. Mitch freezes, his gaze locked on Dylan--pale, her breathing steady under the dim glow of the monitors. Jill is sitting beside Dylan.

JILL
(to Miguel)
You shouldn't have let him in here.
We need to keep our minds open to
any potential causes.

MITCH
What are you suggesting? WHAT ARE
YOU SUGGESTING?

Jill stands, leaves. Mitch runs out after her.

INT. HOSPITAL, HALLWAY - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Jill walks down the hallway, followed by a raging Mitch.

MITCH
IT WAS THE SHADOW MAN AND YOU KNOW.

Jill stops cold, turns around.

JILL
What did you just say?

MITCH
It's the same type of cuts from
when she was a kid. Animalistic.
And you know it's not the masked
murderer because he's got a gun.

JILL
"The Shadow Man" does not exist.

MITCH
Who are you gonna blame this time,
(MORE)

MITCH (CONT'D)
huh? Her dad? He's dead.

Jill's eyes shift.

MITCH
(CONT'D)
He's dead, isn't he? ...You lied.
You lied?!

JILL
Listen to me. With Nathan gone,
she's free to focus on what's
actually going on in her life. You
don't think a grandmother in the
hospital and a masked murderer on
her tail is enough to deal with?
Dylan cannot handle the truth and
neither can you.

MITCH
Try me.

Jill comes closer, whispers with intensity.

JILL
Nathan was my husband. You don't
think I had a better grasp on the
situation than his 6-year-old
daughter? Nathan was a ticking
bomb. Psychedelics friend his brain
and he spiraled. Diagnosed with
severe Schizophrenia, paranoia,
insanity. Long before Dylan's fits
even began. You want a picture?
Imagine a grown man spending every
night outside his daughter's door,
humming in latin.

Mitch falters, but holds her gaze.

JILL
(CONT'D)
I spent all of those days terrified
for my life not because of the
dead, but because of the living.
(MORE)

JILL (CONT'D)

And I'll not have my only daughter follow in his footsteps. You think the shadow man is real? It's his madness infecting her.

MITCH

That's not true.

JILL

Isn't it? Look at her! She's breaking under the weight of your delusions. Those wounds are self-inflicted, Mitch! Every single one. You really believe they'd still be bleeding after ten years?! I come home to find my daughter cut up in a bloody bathtub and you have the nerve to tell me it was a ghost?!

Something changes in Mitch. Jill nods to her own words, internally fighting the validity of what she saw.

JILL

Every paranormal experience you've ever had, I've created a profession out of explaining. Mitch, it is vital that you face this. Ghosts have never been anything other than an allegory for people broken by the past.

EXT. SMALL OUTDOOR CLUB, BACKSTAGE - NIGHT

Dakota makes her way through the crowd, going backstage. She finds Sawyer. They talk over the noise.

DAKOTA

You're mom called. To apologize.

SAWYER

Are you still running away?

Dakota nods.

SAWYER
Did you at least enjoy the show?

She kisses him.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - NIGHT

Mitch enters Dylan's hospital room, soft. No one is inside besides them. Coming closer, he runs his hands along her bandages. He brushes the bangs aside to take in the scar on her head.

A young boy's laughter echos in his head: his own.

INSERT FLASHES:

- Summer 2006. YOUNG MITCH (7) and his mother, CARLEEN (a scar across her face), run through a field, spraying water guns at each other.

YOUNG MITCH
No fair! Mom!

SCREAMS and GROWLS come from the distance. Carleen shoots her head in their direction.

- Young Mitch and Carleen run through the forest.

CARLEEN
(making it fun)
It's a monster, baby! A great big
monster with razor sharp fangs!
We've gotta run!

YOUNG MITCH (V.O.)
Mom?

- Carleen is seen through a crack in the bathroom door, on the phone. Pacing.

CARLEEN
I don't have the summer. No, you
listen to me. HE NEEDS HIS FATHER.
He needs you. And not this version.
...If this is the same as before-
Listen!

She looks out of the room, but young Mitch hides.

YOUNG MITCH (V.O.)
Mommy? I don't like Bill.

- Carleen, tucking young Mitch into bed, looks at him.

CARLEEN
You don't like my boyfriend?

Young Mitch shakes his head.

YOUNG MITCH
He's mean to you. He smells bad.

CARLEEN
Well that's just because of his
work, Mitchie.

YOUNG MITCH
What work does my real dad do?

CARLEEN
Your dad is a concept artist.

YOUNG MITCH
What's that?

Carleen grabs a small box and pulls out the illustration
current Mitch keeps by his bedside. She lays beside little
Mitch and shows it to him.

CARLEEN
Someone who sees beauty before
anyone else.

- Now asleep next to Carleen, young Mitch wakes up to the sound of scratches on his window. He shoves his mom. She wakes up in a rush, searching for a weapon.

YOUNG MITCH
(crying)
Mommy, what's happening?

CARLEEN
Oh, it's just the monster! Trying to spook us, that crazy thing. I need you to defend the fort all right? You think you can do that?

He nods.

CARLEEN
(CONT'D)
OK. But you've gotta be totally invisible. Can you be invisible, Mitchie? OK, come quick. Into the invisibility chamber!

She puts Mitch into a closet. Holding back tears, she touches his face and kisses his head before closing the door.

INT. HOSPITAL, ROOM - NIGHT

Mitch leans over Dylan, crying. She wakes up, eyes far off and voice hoarse.

DYLAN
Mitch? I knew he was coming. The shadow man. I could feel it. And I tried to stay awake, but-

MITCH
Hey. It's OK.

DYLAN
I didn't want you to be blamed like my-

MITCH
I know. I wasn't.

Dylan calms.

DYLAN
He'll stay away for a little while
now... Don't tell them you believe.

Mitch smiles, weak.

DYLAN
(CONT'D)
I had the strangest dream that my
dad was still alive. Did they
mention anything about him?

MITCH
...no.

Dylan nestles her head into Mitch's hand.

EXT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Jill and Miguel pull into the driveway. Dylan and Mitch are in the backseat, Carrie's car behind them. Jill catches sight of Sawyer and Dakota sitting on the porch.

JILL
Oh. I'll get cookies.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, LIVING ROOM - NIGHT (CONTINUOUS)

Dylan, Mitch, Carrie, Sawyer, Dakota, and Miguel get cozy in the living room, relatively calm.

DAKOTA
I'm glad you're all right, Dylan.

DYLAN
Thanks for coming.

Dylan looks at Sawyer: you and Dakota? Yeah. You and Mitch? Yeah. Dylan smiles, a little less somber.

DYLAN
Miguel, I've been meaning to give
this to you.

Dylan produces Candice's letter to Sandra from her pocket.

DYLAN (O.S.)
This is a letter from Cuppa to
Sandra Hugh dated last Summer.

Jill emerges with cookies. As she puts the cookies down, she clocks the book she was reading at the hospital and slows.

DYLAN (O.S.)
I think she was running from the
same man who tried to shoot me.

Miguel looks at the letter like it's gold.

JILL
Sandra's alive?

They stare at Jill's intensity as she goes to the letter.

DYLAN
She's been hiding in Boston. Still
trying to prove Raymond's
innocence.

Tears fill Jill's eyes. Dakota leans into Sawyer, munching on a cookie. She whispers.

DAKOTA
What's happening right now?

Sawyer shrugs.

There's a knock on the door. Miguel opens it to find Lexie and MIA BENNET. Mia nudges Lexie. Lexie holds up the MASK.

LEXIE
I found this in my step dad's closet.

CARRIE
...Fuck.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, JILL'S ROOM - NIGHT

Jill and Miguel shut the blinds.

MIGUEL (O.S.)
He'll know it's gone. We all have to hide.

The mask lies on Jill's bedroom carpet. As Mitch, Jill, and Miguel look at it, Dylan passes out black clothing.

MITCH
Black Willow Bulletin, 1989.

Mitch pulls out the newspaper print. It reads: "BLACK WILLOW BARON MICHAEL HUGH FOUND INNOCENT AFTER FATAL ATTACK."
Miguel pulls up a photo of Chief Hodge on his phone, comparing them.

MIGUEL
I'll be damned.

JILL
The bone structure... plastic surgery?

Miguel paces, running a hand over his face. Dylan heads downstairs, but Mitch grabs her arm.

MITCH
Where are you going?

DYLAN

The silo. To see if she left a clue
that'll lead us to the VHS tapes.

MIGUEL

Not alone.

Mitch follows her out, along with Sawyer and Dakota.

MIGUEL (O.S.)

Lexie. In a court of law, the mask
could have been planted.

Miguel, Jill, Mia, and Carrie surround Lexie.

MIGUEL

What else can you tell me?

LEXIE

Uh. The house. He can't demolish it
soon enough.

CARRIE

K so there's obviously something in
the house. He tried to stop Dylan
and Mitch too right? Maybe the guy
believes in ghosts.

Miguel looks at a doubtful Jill, cocking his head. Maybe...

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, SILO ATTIC - NIGHT

Dylan, Mitch, Sawyer, and Dakota rummage through the attic.
Dakota sees the GOOD CREST on Cuppa's ghost gear chest.

DAKOTA

Dylan... this symbol.

Dylan joins her. Sawyer is looking at the ceiling mural.

DYLAN
I think it's a family crest.

DAKOTA
I've seen it. On my tarot deck.
Carrie and I have the same one.
It's super popular.

Dakota dumps her purse's contents. She fishes out the tarot deck, shows Dylan the Good Crest on the back's design. Mitch and Sawyer join them. Mitch grabs the card case, reading.

MITCH
Created by Candice Good. Just last
Summer.

DYLAN
...Search.

All four dig through the cards, trying to find a clue. Sawyer pulls one of the cards and holds it against the mural.

SAWYER
It's the same image.

MITCH
What is that card?

DAKOTA
Traditionally, the death card. But
in this deck it's called A Grand
Hush.

Dylan thinks HARD.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, SILO SECOND FLOOR - NIGHT

Mitch stands in front of the black board he used to teach Dylan. On it is written "A GRAND HUSH."

MITCH

There is something about this phrase Dylan's grandmother wants us to know. Clue: it's related to the death card. Now go.

DAKOTA

It's a word jumble.

SAWYER

A what?

DAKOTA

You know, like one of those things where you mix up all the letters and get another word.

MITCH

Like an anagram?

DAKOTA

OK, wow. Listen. If you two know so many words why don't you try and unjumble that one?

Mitch and Sawyer react with arms upheld in defense: woahh!

Meanwhile, Dylan steps up to the board and writes "SANDRA HUGH." They all look at it.

SAWYER

Oh.

Mitch lights up, takes Dylan by the shoulders.

MITCH

The death card! The graveyard book! What do you think's buried in Sandra's spot if she was never really dead?

Dylan smiles. Dakota JUMPS like a little girl.

DAKOTA
Dude I am pumped! Where's the book?

Mitch grins.

INT. KLAYPOOL RESIDENCE, UPSTAIRS - NIGHT

Miguel plops a copy of the graveyard book onto the bed.
Mitch flips through it as Dylan, Miguel, Mia, Jill, Dakota,
Sawyer, and Carrie hover.

MIA
We have to go to hell house before
sunrise.

DYLAN
Why?

MIGUEL
Testimony. Before it gets
demolished in the morning.

He steps aside, making a call.

DAKOTA
Who's testimony?

MIGUEL
(on the phone)
This is Detective Rodriquez. I need
a helicopter ride to Boston.

JILL
(still not
convinced)
...Raymond Cole.

Dylan looks at Jill, stunned. Mitch stops at Sandra's
coordinates.

MITCH
Found it.

DYLAN

Let's go.

EXT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT

In the forest, followed by Dylan, Dakota, Sawyer, Carrie, Mia, and Lexie, Mitch twirls his shovel like a kid playing with a toy lightsaber. Dylan holds the graveyard book.

DYLAN

This is the place.

Sawyer kneels down, dusting off the Good Crest.

SAWYER

Check it out.

Dylan shakes her head in disbelief.

MITCH

Mia, can you keep watch?

MIA

Excuse me?

MITCH

You're a boxer right?

MIA

Not by choice.

MITCH

Well in that case, remind me to thank your parents later. If he finds us, we're done.

Mitch lifts his shovel and thrusts it into ground.

EXT. SANDRA'S HOUSE - NIGHT

Jill approaches Sandra's front door, coat flapping.

SANDRA
JILL?!

They hug tightly.

JILL
Are you able to hop into a
helicopter right now?

SANDRA
What? What for?

JILL
How do you feel about one last
goodbye with Raymond?

SANDRA
Are you serious?!

EXT. BLACK WILLOW WOODS - NIGHT

Lexie scrolls on her phone as Carrie doodles into the ground
with a stick. Mitch digs.

CARRIE
I thought grave robbing would be
more fun.

LEXIE
At least you look good in black.

Carrie doesn't look at her.

CARRIE
Umm you're not allowed to talk to
me. You slept with my boyfriend,
'member?

MIA
What?! Lexie...

Something ruffles in the bushes.

DAKOTA
Wait. Guys, did you hear that?

SAWYER
It's probably just wind.

Mitch hits a box with his shovel.

MITCH
Got it.

LEXIE
I'm sorry, Carrie. But doesn't me
putting my whole family on the line
like kind of make up for it?

Mitch lifts the box out. Dylan opens it, her breath catching
as she sees the VHS tapes inside. Mitch puts them in his
bag.

CARRIE
Excuse me. Your step dad is a
murderer. Am I supposed to be
impressed that you told the police?

LEXIE
My mom and I could lose everything!

The sound in the bushes strengthens. They all look.

DAKOTA
That was not wind.

SAWYER
Run.

They run, heading uphill towards Hell House.

EXT. HELL HOUSE - NIGHT

The group of seven comes upon Hell House, their silhouettes stark.

INT. HELL HOUSE, FOYER - NIGHT

Lexie uses her own key to unlock Hell House.

LEXIE
I can't believe I'm helping you
guys after you ratted me out.

DYLAN
As opposed to what, Lexie?

Lexie's eyes widen. She shrugs.

DYLAN
I'm sorry for ratting you out. But
you can do better than Parker Hall.

Dylan looks at Mia and Sawyer, then back to Lexie.

DYLAN
(CONT'D)
You three keep watch, OK? And thank
you.

INT. HELL HOUSE, STAIRCASE - NIGHT

Mitch, Carrie, and Dakota follow Dylan upstairs.

DAKOTA
Just like old times, right Dylan?

DYLAN
If only I weren't sober...

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT

Dakota and Carrie arrange candles for the séance in Sandra's old room.

DYLAN
You guys do seem to really know
what you're doing.

DAKOTA
Doing sketchy shit together since
12-years-old, Baby.

Dakota and Carrie fist bump. The door creaks open. It's Mitch.

MITCH
She's... here.

He opens it wider, revealing Sandra.

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Jill comforts Sandra while they sit on the bed. Mitch pulls out all of the ghost hunting equipment as Miguel watches.

MIGUEL
What's this?

MITCH
An SB7 Spirit Box. Ghosts speak
through them.

MIGUEL
I can't believe I'm saying this,
but if Raymond materializes, you
know, we might have enough to prove
ghosts exist. Then I could take
another look at Nathan's case.

MITCH
Dylan's dad?

MIGUEL
Thanks for not telling her he's
alive, by the way. We really
appreciate that.

Miguel walks away, revealing Dylan. Mitch locks eyes with
her. She heard.

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Dakota leads the seance. Jill holds Sandra's hand. Miguel
stands on the outskirts, keeping an eye on equipment.

DAKOTA
Raymond Cole, we summon you from
the other side. Cross into our
world; join us tonight.

INT. HELL HOUSE, UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

Dylan storms out into the hallway, followed by Mitch.

DYLAN
How could you not tell me my dad is
alive?

MITCH
It's not my place.

DYLAN
Bullshit!

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Jill looks at Miguel. He looks up, shaking his head.
Nothing.

DAKOTA
Raymond, we open this space to you.
Cross over and reveal yourself.

The skeptics look around. Jill almost laughs.

INT. HELL HOUSE, UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

In the hallway, Mitch stammers.

MITCH

I've been worried about you! Dylan!
Why do your wounds still bleed
after ten years? What do you mean
you flew on a broomstick the other
day? Don't you think that's a
little crazier than you're giving
it credit for?

DYLAN

You do think I'm crazy.

MITCH

I said it's crazy. I didn't say
you're crazy.

DYLAN

What you meant is all that matters!

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Miguel catches activity on one of the machines.

MIGUEL

I got a temperature drop.

SANDRA

Really?

A thumping sounds from inside the walls. Everyone flinches.

DAKOTA

Sandra is here to say hi.

The MEL-METER SCREECHES. Everyone cowers.

INT. HELL HOUSE, UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

Dylan swells up, in a rage.

DYLAN

What about what we saw in the mirror? When you got so excited that you kissed me? You've seen them.

MITCH

I saw smoke and broke the mirror so fast I couldn't even analyze it because, Dylan, that's the closest I've ever come to actually seeing anything!

INT. HELL HOUSE SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

The group sits in their seance.

SANDRA

Raymond... I've missed you so much.
Do you remember me?

They wait. Static... No voices.

SANDRA

Why isn't he talking?

DAKOTA

Stay calm. Give him time.

RAYMOND (O.S.)

Sandra Hugh.

SANDRA

Oh, my God!

RAYMOND (O.S.)

I love.

CARRIE
Holy shit.

SANDRA
Raymond!

JILL
I don't think she can handle this,
Miguel.

MIGUEL
Wait. I got something.

On Miguel's screen, a GLOWING BALL shoots into Sandra.

MIGUEL
(CONT'D)
It went inside of her!

DAKOTA
What?!

Sandra CONVULSES.

SANDRA
Raymond! I love you! I'm so sorry!

All the equipment spikes--EMF meters, MEL-Meter, and SB7
blaring with shrill, overlapping sounds.

JILL
Sandra, are you okay? Dakota,
what's wrong with her?

DAKOTA
I don't know!

INT. HELL HOUSE, UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

Mitch continues as though he's finally speaking freely.

MITCH

I work at a graveyard! I live on a graveyard! Since seven years old, I've done everything in my power to connect with ghosts including believing relentlessly and allowing them in. DON'T YOU THINK I WOULD HAVE SEEN MY MOM BY NOW?!

DYLAN

...Mitch.

He shakes his head, crying.

MITCH

She's gone. Your dad was lying...
They're not real.

MIGUEL (O.S.)

The orb, it's going!

JILL (O.S.)

What? Where?

SCREAMS come from Sandra's room. Dylan and Mitch rush to it.

INT. HELL HOUSE, SANDRA'S ROOM - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Mitch and Dylan burst into Sandra's room to find Sandra convulsing, the group panicking, and Raymond's ghost fully visible on the mirror.

Mitch freezes- then, a familiar smile stretches across his face. He yanks the monitor from Miguel.

MITCH

I'll take it from here. Thanks.

Jill, holding Sandra's hand, looks to Dylan.

JILL

She's freezing.

Dylan grabs Sandra's other hand.

DYLAN
Just relax. He's here for you.

SANDRA
I'm scared.

DYLAN
I know.

SANDRA
I'm scared, Dylan.

DYLAN
I know. Trust me. But you've gotta
let the fear go, OK? Give up
control and it'll be all right.

Mitch watches Dylan as she coaches Sandra through deep
breaths.

SANDRA
Raymond! I love you always. I know
you're innocent. I'll prove it, I
promise.

MITCH
I'm getting something!

RAYMOND
Innocent. Love Sandra. Dad. Spit.

CARRIE
What did he say? Did he say spit?

Small items POP. Raymond holds a small vile of clear liquid.
He puts his arm through the mirror.

MIGUEL
DAD. SPIT. IT'S SPIT! MICHAEL

HUGH'S DNA TO MATCH! WE'VE GOT IT.

Sandra takes the vile. Raymond continues escaping the mirror.

DAKOTA
He's about the materialize!

His hand is almost on Sandra's face when-

GUNSHOTS fire from downstairs. Raymond disappears. Sandra goes to call for him, but Jill covers her mouth.

MIGUEL
...Michael Hugh.

HODGE (O.S.)
Oh, Velma! Don't you care to keep
your little Scooby gang? If so, I
reckon you come down about just
this instant.

DAKOTA
Sawyer's down there.

Miguel reaches for the gun on his belt.

MIGUEL
Do not go down.

HODGE (O.S.)
I SAID INSTANT.

Miguel starts to leave.

JILL
I'm coming with you.

He shakes his head and kisses her, leaving the room.

They wait in baited breath, huddled next to one another. Sandra comforts Dakota while she cries.

More GUNSHOTS. They all duck. Jill is in agony.

JILL

Fuck.

Dylan watches her mom.

INSERT FLASHES:

- Dylan flying on a broomstick.
- Dylan arguing with her mom, wind rising.
- Dylan in the witch's costume.

Dylan bolts out of the door. Jill and Mitch look at each other, panicked.

INT. HELL HOUSE, UPSTAIRS HALLWAY - NIGHT

Dylan is on her way downstairs, determined, when Mitch grabs her hand. He looks at her: what are you doing?!

Dylan presses her head to his.

DYLAN

Don't laugh.

INT. HELL HOUSE, FOYER - NIGHT

Hodge has Sawyer in a choke hold. As Dylan comes down the stairs, she sees Miguel tied up and gagged with a shot wound on his leg. Lexie sits on the couch, terrified, and Mia is nowhere to be seen.

DYLAN
Is this any way to treat your
friends, Chief Hodge? Or should I
call you Michael Hugh?

Hodge smirks, tightening his grip around Sawyer.

HODGE
Well well if it ain't little Velma.
As a matter of fact, it's a damn
shame to be losing 'em on account
of you, ya know. But, eh, a man can
get so attached to the tabs he
keeps.

Hodge points his gun, aiming it at Dylan.

HODGE
Reckon it's about time I finish
what I started.

MITCH (O.S.)
Dylan!

Hodge, about to pull the trigger, turns to the sound of
Mitch's voice. Mitch WHACKS him with his shovel. Hodge
stumbles, releasing Sawyer.

MITCH
I'm sorry I lied to you.

DYLAN
What?!

Mia emerges, FIGHTING Hodge. Mitch steps closer to Dylan.

MITCH
Your mom can be very convincing.

DYLAN
Well, she's never gotten to me.

Hodge's gun falls and FIRES, shooting Sawyer in the shoulder.

DYLAN
SAWYER!!!

Dylan slides past Mitch to Sawyer as the gun slides into a fireplace. Sawyer is seething in pain. Dylan raises her hand from below his shoulder. It's covered in blood.

SAWYER
OW.

DYLAN
Lexie, give me your sweater!

Mitch inches towards the gun as Lexie moves to help. But Hodge gains on Mia, holding her in a lock.

HODGE
LEXIE WILSON, YOU HELP THAT BOY AND
YOU AND YOUR MOM ARE BACK ON THE
DAMN STREETS, YOU UNDERSTAND ME?

DYLAN
LEXIE, YOUR SWEATER!

Lexie looks at Hodge and sticks up her middle finger. She dives to help Sawyer as Mia elbows Hodge in the gut. The fight resumes.

MITCH
Dylan, exactly! You think for
yourself.

DYLAN
Mitch, the gun!

Mitch goes for the gun, still yelling across the room.

MITCH
Why do you think it killed me so
(MORE)

MITCH (CONT'D)
much to watch you suffer?!

Mitch grabs the gun.

MITCH
(soft)
Your mind is unique as snow.

Mia sends Hodge smashing into a MIRROR. It falls, SHATTERING over Mitch. Dylan freezes before approaching. She pushes the mirror off Mitch. He's unconscious and maimed. He looks... Behind her back, Hodge grabs the unattended gun and points it toward Lexie, who shields herself.

HODGE
YOU UNGRATEFUL-

A breeze ruffles the curtains. Hodge stops cold, looking psychotic.

HODGE
You feel that? It's him! That
freezing son of a bitch at it
again!

Hodge jumps, spins, shoots at the fireplace. Everyone ducks, screams. The lightbulbs flicker. Hodge fires at all them.

HODGE
Go ahead, you cold-blooded bastard!
Want to ruin my life all over
again? Well, come an' get it!!!

Hodge is suddenly paralyzed, rising slowly in mid-air.

MIA
Is it the ghost?!

LEXIE
...No. It's not.

Mia follows Lexie's eye line. Dylan is rising from her spot beside Mitch, eye's dark and dangerous. Dylan SCREAMS and Hodge flings into the air, back arched, jerking wildly.

MIA
(muffled)
She's going to kill him!

LEXIE
(muffled)
Dylan!

And Mitch LAUGHS.

Dylan blinks, eyes returning, and Hodge smacks to the floor. Dylan drops to her knees beside Mitch, who's totally awake.

MITCH
(half delirious)
Think I can take a ride on your
broomstick some time, Babygirl?

Dylan embraces Mitch as though she thought she'd lost him.

DYLAN
Absolutely not.

Somewhere behind them, now untied, Miguel is pointing the gun at an out-cold Ronald Hodge.

MIGUEL (O.S.)
Ronald Hodge, you're under arrest
for the murder of Raymond Cole and
for the attempted murder of Candice
Good, Dylan Klaypool, and Lexie
Wilson.

The sirens start.

DYLAN (V.O.)
I once said no companionship was
worth a compromise of character.

EXT. BLACK WILLOW TOWN CENTER - DAY

Morgan waves to a crowd. Cameras flash.

DYLAN (V.O.)
And I burnt history... repeatedly.
Just to sanctify my spirit.

EXT. BLACK WILLOW SUBURBS/WILSON RESIDENCE - DAY

A Autumnal, suburban front door. A newspaper is tossed to it.

DYLAN
If I've learned anything this
Autumn, it's how impure the pursuit
for purity can become.

The newspaper shows Morgan's photo, titled: "Guilt-ridden Mayor Hall apologizes, reveals truth about abandoned Hugh estate."

INT. BENNET RESIDENCE, FRONT DOOR (CONTINUOUS)

DYLAN
Sometimes that looks like a witch
hunt, bigotry.

Newspaper in hand, Mia walks through the kitchen where Lexie and CHARLOTTE are cooking a Thanksgiving feast.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Other times it's a refusal of your
self.

Mia and Lexie look at one another with something on the verge of romance. Lexie turns away, worried and faking a smile.

EXT. GARDNER RESIDENCE - DAY

Dakota is in a red scarf. Snow decorates the floor.

DYLAN (V.O.)
I still have a thousand unanswered
questions about my life before I
can even begin to uncover the sky.

Sawyer, with a shoulder cast, one-handedly helps Dakota and HARLOW GARDNER pack their things into the hippy van. Sawyer hugs Dakota, then kisses her. She gets into the car, waving goodbye.

INT. PSYCH WARD FOR THE CRIMINALLY INSANE - DAY

Nathan's cell doors open. He looks up, on the mend.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Is my dad totally innocent?

Miguel smiles at him.

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GRAVEYARD - NIGHT

It's snowing. Carrie leaves flowers on her brother's grave.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Am I evil? Is there something to my
dreams?

Mitch sees her, waves hello. It's warm, but distant. Healed.

EXT. VERLICE RESIDENCE, GRAVEYARD - NIGHT (MOMENTS LATER)

Mitch digs through the snow.

DYLAN (V.O.)
You see, I used to know the answer
to all of these, but I digress.

He looks up to Dylan's window. She's bathed in a golden glow, writing.

DYLAN (V.O.)
Ghosts are ever constant creatures,
like carousels of memory.

JILL (O.S.)
(distant call)
Dylan! We're opening gifts!

Dylan catches Mitch staring.

DYLAN (V.O.)
One must move forward if they mean
to stay alive.

With a uncharacteristic smile, she turns off her nightlight.

CREDITS.

INT. BLACK CAT COFFEE SHOP - NIGHT

Veda has her back to the counter, making coffee.

CHAYTON (O.S.)
How's my favorite cousin?

CHAYTON WARCLOUD is on the opposite end of the counter.

VEDA
Last I checked, you're dead to me.

CHAYTON
This is serious. I took it last
night.

Chayton looks around, he lifts the photo of a MONSTER.

CHAYTON
Remember the Summer of beasts?

For the first time, Veda is afraid.

END OF EPISODE